

COLLENA SHAKTI

Rajasthani Folk * Abhinaya * Indian Fusion
Bellydance *

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With over two decades of immersion in the artistic traditions of India, Colleena Shakti is a world-renowned dancer whose work embodies the intersection of devotion, tradition, and innovation. Since moving to India in 2001 for rigorous apprentice-style training, she has dedicated her life to the mastery of Odissi Classical Dance under the legendary Smt. Sujata Mohapatra, while also becoming a leading authority on the vibrant Folk Dances of Rajasthan.

As the founder of the Shakti School of Dance in the historic Old Rang Nath Temple in Pushkar, Colleena has created a bridge between timeless Indian aesthetics and modern expression. Her unique methodology is built on a solid foundation of Natya Shastra, Yoga, and Martial Arts, allowing her to respectfully navigate the space between ancient heritage and contemporary fusion. Whether she is performing on global stages or hosting immersive residencies at Villa Shakti Crete, Colleena's dance is more than movement—it is a holistic vision of art that inspires students to move deeper.

VAISHALI SAGAR

Folk Fusion * Cheraw

Folk Fusion * Cheraw Folk Fusion *

Cheraw Folk Fusion * Cheraw Folk Fusion *

Cheraw Folk Fusion * Cheraw

Folk Fusion * Cheraw

Folk Fusion * Cheraw

Vaishali Sagar, hailing from Mumbai, India, is a distinguished figure in the world of dance. She holds a master's degree in Indian Folk Dance, earned under the tutelage of Guru Rooma Banerjee. Currently, she serves as the director of Kalanjay Dance Academy in Mumbai, a prestigious institution with an enrollment of 900 students and an alumni network of over 5000.

Vaishali is an expert in traditional Indian folk dances and Bollywood dance styles, imparting her knowledge and passion to her students.

Vaishali has also represented India in various international folk dance festivals based in Italy, Austria, Turkey, Greece, Germany, Bulgaria, Czech Republic, South Korea, Poland, Belgium just to name a few.

SHAMPA GOPIKRISHNA

Garba * Mayurbhanj Chhau *
Garba * Mayurbhanj Chhau * Garba *
Mayurbhanj Chhau * Garba * Mayurbhanj
Chhau * Garba * Mayurbhanj Chhau *
Garba * Mayurbhanj Chhau *

Garba * Mayurbhanj Chhau *

Shampa Gopikrishna, hailing from Mumbai, India, is a celebrated choreographer and the daughter of the late Natraj Shri Gopikrishna, a legendary Kathak exponent. She embarked on her dance journey at age 4, mastering Indian classical dance forms under her father's guidance and other esteemed gurus. Later, she embraced western dance styles, honing her skills at the Terence Lewis Contemporary Dance Company (TLCDC) in Mumbai.

Shampa's choreographic prowess spans across theatre, film, and TV. She has choreographed for musicals like "Monsoon Wedding" and "Disney's Aladdin", and films such as "Padmaavat" and "Ram

Leela". Her work on the dance show "Jhalak Dikhhla Jaa" earned her two victories, a unique achievement.

In addition to her choreography, Shampa is passionate about teaching dance. She conducts workshops in various dance styles around the world, sharing her love for dance with others.

HAMEED KHAN KAWA

Live Music *

Live Music *Live Music *Live Music *Live
Music *Live Music *Live Music *Live Music
*Live Music *
Live Music *

Live Music *

An internationally renowned tabla maestro and artistic director, Hameed Khan Kawa carries the soul of Rajasthan in every beat. Inheriting a deep musical lineage from Jaipur, he has spent decades as a "humanity walker," tirelessly bridging the gap

between Indian folk traditions and global contemporary sounds. As the visionary leader behind world-famous ensembles like Musafir, Jaipur Kawa Brass Band, and Kawa Circus, Hameed has performed on the world's most prestigious stages—from the UK's Edgbaston Stadium to the recent viral hit on Coke Studio Bharat alongside Sunidhi Chauhan.

A master of both classical and folk percussion, Hameed is a celebrated innovator who has collaborated with legends such as Ustad Zakir Hussain and the Gypsy Kings. At GIDF 2026, he brings his immense expertise to the heart of the festival, accompanying our workshops and performances with live music. His presence ensures that every step taken is fueled by the authentic, pulsing energy of the Thar Desert, creating a truly immersive and spiritual experience for every dancer.

DESIHOP

Kuthu * Desi Afro *

Kuthu * Desi Afro *Kuthu * Desi Afro *Kuthu *

Desi Afro *Kuthu * Desi Afro *Kuthu * Desi Afro *

Kuthu * Desi Afro *
Kuthu * Desi Afro *

Kuthu * Desi Afro *

DesiHop began in early 2023 in Frankfurt, born from a simple idea shared by three Indian dancers Gokul Gopi, Saumya Singh, and Rayeez Mohammed: to create a space where movement could feel like home. What started as shared practice sessions soon grew into a collective voice, blending Bollywood, hip-hop, Afro, and the raw energy of Tamil kuthu into a powerful fusion that speaks across cultures.

Built as a safe and inclusive platform for South-Asian dancers, DesiHop has steadily grown through consistency and community. Over the past 18 months, the collective has hosted more than 15 workshops across Germany, showing up month after month, city after city. Alongside this journey, DesiHop continues to nurture its roots through regular weekly Bollywood-fusion classes at Tanzschule Weiss in Offenbach. Today, DesiHop is not just a dance style—it's a growing movement shaped by people, persistence, and the belief that dance can connect worlds.

MANASI KHANNA

Giddha *

Giddha *Giddha *Giddha *Giddha *Giddha
*Giddha *Giddha *Giddha *Giddha *Giddha *
Giddha *

Giddha *

She is a key figure in the European Punjabi folk scene. As a lead force behind Amsterdam Bhangra, she has been instrumental in bringing the high-octane energy and cultural depth of North Indian folk to the heart of Europe. Her journey is defined by a commitment to authenticity and the belief that dance is the ultimate bridge between communities.

Manasi's dance journey has reached the grandest heights, including performing as part of the dance crew for global icon Diljit Dosanjh during his historic "Dil-Luminati" tour in the Netherlands.

SWAPNIL DAGLIYA

Kalbeliya * Lavani *

Kalbeliya * Lavani *Kalbeliya * Lavani

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*Kalbeliya * Lavani *

Kalbeliya * Lavani *

Kalbeliya * Lavani *

Kalbeliya * Lavani *

Swapnil Dagliya is the Artistic Director and co-founder of Shoonya Dance Centre in Ghent, Belgium, and leads ABC a Bollywood Company. Born and raised near Mumbai, he is a certified instructor with Learn Bhangra and holds a diploma in Indian folk dance. Blending his Indian roots with training in ballet, jazz, modern, and contemporary dance,

Swapnil aims to make Indian dance accessible to international audiences. His extensive training includes graduation from the Broadway Dance Center in New York and advanced studies at Opus Ballet in Florence, Italy. He is also the curator of the annual Gent India Dans Festival.